the top tables. Following a careful process administered by the IMF, the United States eventually set the terms to unseat Taiwan and give China 3.63 percent of voting power, as well as a quota allocation, which China promptly attempted to increase.[50] China also gained an executive director (ED) position on the board when it regained its seat in 1980. More recently, the United States has worked informally to support giving China more senior roles and positions in the IMF and World Bank, even while Congress delayed implementation of the agreed package of reforms of voting shares. It is important to note that China had begun pressing for strong reforms of the governance structures of the World Bank and IMF in 2005, a year before Moscow initiated the BRICs consultations.[51]

A second example of the U.S. strategy to facilitate *joiner*s centers on Russia in the early 1990s, when it was reeling from economic crisis after the collapse of the Soviet Union. Although the United States and its G7 partners were unwilling to fire a big financial bazooka in support of Russia's attempted reforms,[52] Washington allowed the IMF technical staff, then guesstimating Russian figures, to arrive at an artificially high quota share in the IMF on the basis of a generous and inflated assessment of Russia's economic size. This was done in order to keep Moscow under the Bretton Woods tent and broadly in the Western orbit. Russia also lobbied hard for, and was granted, a constituency-free ED position in 1992, despite its relatively small economy, and was invited to join the G7 political club (albeit not the G7 finance ministers' group). These boosts functioned as additional side-payments to reflect Russia's prominence as a democratizing former superpower.[53] Western governments sought to contain the Russian political backlash against American support for Russia's political and economic transformation.

Unlike past historical periods, mutually beneficial cooperation has been possible, as John Ruggie argues, because it emanates not solely from the prevailing distribution of power, but rather rests on a foundation of institutions and rules conceived as a "fusion of power and legitimate social purpose."[54] A new distribution of power, in this view, may involve new instruments but still could "reflect shared purposes,"[55] such as multilateralism and openness, rather than aiming for the utopian goal of a "harmony of interests." Similarly, besides the "distribution of power and the hierarchy of prestige," Robert Gilpin specifies "a set of rights and rules" as